

FIFA World Cup 2026

Prediction Report

Stage: Round of 32

Run date: 2026-06-26 (report created: 2026-06-26)

Headline	Value
Title pick	Argentina (16.4%)
Most likely finalists	Argentina & Spain
Golden Boot pick	Lionel Messi (Argentina) – proj 7.7
Teams simulated	32
Monte Carlo runs	10,000

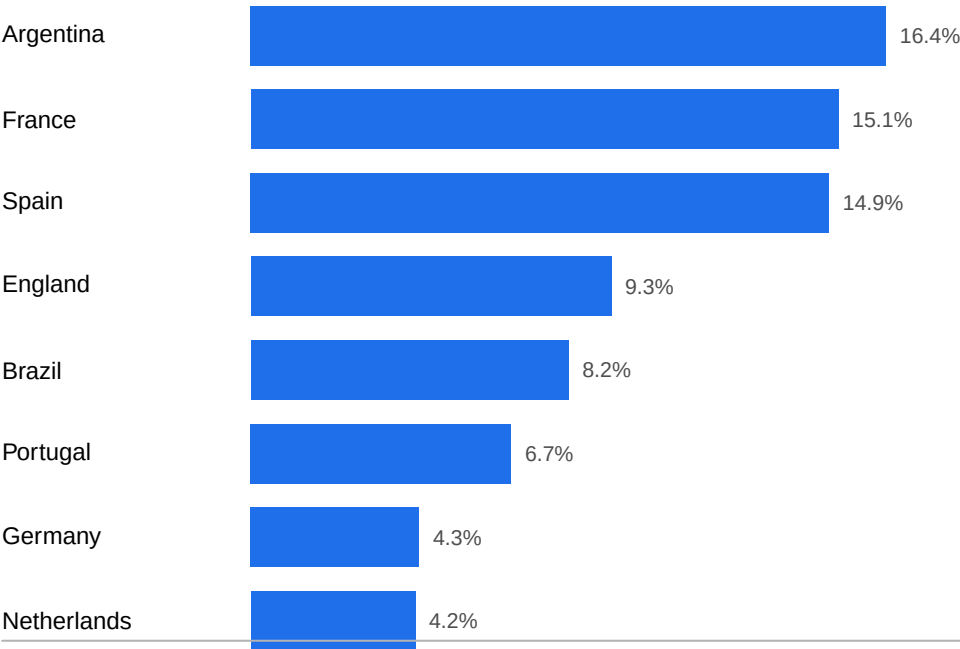
Model: ridge-shrunk Poisson (Dixon-Coles) goal model + Monte Carlo bracket simulation

Tournament Progression

As of 2026-06-26 – probabilities from 10,000 simulations

Team	R16	QF	SF	Final	Win
Argentina	73%	60%	41%	27%	16.4%
France	79%	57%	41%	25%	15.1%
Spain	79%	58%	40%	26%	14.9%
England	83%	63%	32%	18%	9.3%
Brazil	72%	44%	30%	16%	8.2%
Portugal	77%	48%	25%	13%	6.7%
Germany	64%	42%	21%	10%	4.3%
Netherlands	62%	31%	18%	9%	4.2%
USA	69%	26%	13%	6%	2.6%
Croatia	64%	34%	14%	6%	2.4%
Belgium	59%	27%	11%	5%	2.1%
Mexico	62%	24%	12%	5%	2.0%
Colombia	53%	28%	11%	4%	1.8%
Canada	66%	28%	11%	4%	1.4%
Uruguay	27%	18%	8%	4%	1.4%
Norway	47%	23%	9%	3%	1.3%

Title-winning probability



Round of 32 – Match Predictions

Advancer = win the tie; 90' result and likeliest score also shown

Match	Tie	Advance	90'	Score
South Africa v Canada	Confirmed	Canada (66%)	Away win	1–1 (11%)
Germany v Senegal *	Projected	Germany (64%)	Home win	1–1 (13%)
Netherlands v Morocco	Confirmed	Netherlands (62%)	Home win	1–1 (13%)
Brazil v Japan	Confirmed	Brazil (72%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
England v Cape Verde	Confirmed	England (84%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)
Egypt v Czechia	Confirmed	Czechia (51%)	Away win	1–1 (13%)
USA v Bosnia and Herzegovina	Confirmed	USA (70%)	Home win	1–1 (11%)
Spain v Austria	Confirmed	Spain (80%)	Home win	2–0 (11%)
Switzerland v Belgium	Confirmed	Belgium (58%)	Away win	1–1 (13%)
Portugal v Ghana	Confirmed	Portugal (77%)	Home win	1–1 (11%)
Australia v Iran	Confirmed	Iran (52%)	Away win	1–1 (13%)
Argentina v Uruguay	Confirmed	Argentina (72%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
France v Sweden *	Projected	France (80%)	Home win	2–0 (11%)
Mexico v Ecuador *	Projected	Mexico (61%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
Colombia v Norway *	Projected	Colombia (53%)	Home win	1–1 (13%)
Croatia v Korea Republic *	Projected	Croatia (64%)	Home win	1–1 (13%)

* 5 tie(s) marked Projected use model-estimated participants (group stage not yet final

/ slot unconfirmed). Confirmed ties are locked from reported results. Update

knockout_bracket.csv as matchups are confirmed and re-run.

Top–Scorer Forecast

Projected final goals = current + expected remaining

Golden Boot projection

Player	Team	Now	Exp+	Proj
Lionel Messi	Argentina	5	2.69	7.69
Kylian Mbappe	France	4	2.55	6.55
Vinicius Junior	Brazil	4	1.8	5.8
Erling Haaland	Norway	4	1.46	5.46
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	3	1.75	4.75
Jonathan David	Canada	3	1.5	4.5
Harry Kane	England	2	2.23	4.23
Deniz Undav	Germany	3	1.21	4.21
Julian Alvarez	Argentina	2	1.58	3.58
Alvaro Morata	Spain	2	1.44	3.44
Lamine Yamal	Spain	2	1.31	3.31
Christian Pulisic	USA	2	1.2	3.2

Top–scorer picks for Round of 32

Player	Team	Exp goals
Lionel Messi	Argentina	0.854
Kylian Mbappe	France	0.798
Erling Haaland	Norway	0.778
Harry Kane	England	0.72
Jonathan David	Canada	0.693
Vinicius Junior	Brazil	0.655
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	0.638
Mohamed Salah	Egypt	0.574

Recommendations & Method

How to play these predictions

STRATEGY: Back clear favourites where the model is confident (>60% advance)

to bank safe points; differentiate on tighter ties and on the Golden Boot,

where a well-placed contender on a deep team can outscore the favourite.

Model's title pick: Argentina (16.4%).

Champion pick: Argentina (16.4%). Safe R16 backers: England, France, Spain,

Portugal, Argentina, Brazil.

Methodology

1. Team strength starts from Elo priors adjusted by researched form/injury notes.

2. A Dixon-Coles bivariate Poisson model turns strength into scoreline distributions;

parameters are refined by a ridge-penalised fit on observed results (shrinking to priors).

3. A Monte Carlo simulation plays out the bracket many times -> progression probabilities,

with extra time and strength-tilted penalty shootouts for knockout ties.

4. Each team's expected goals are shared among its players (form-adjusted) and weighted by

how far the team is projected to advance -> per-stage and Golden Boot scorer forecasts.

Data provenance

Verified: group draw, reported group winners, R32 anchor ties, Golden Boot tallies.

Illustrative/projected: unplayed scores and not-yet-confirmed bracket slots.

Refresh input_data/ CSVs with official data and re-run to update everything.